



"Ranveig? Maarika? Tisket?" Gibraltar sounded even more panicked. "Dammit, this is why I hate being mission control. Nobody tells me what's happening! Will somebody give me a non-pooka answer, please?"

"Time to cut the chatter on the line. Maarika, report," Dolaidh said, offering his first input.

"We're in, barely. Haven't had a chance to look for the vault yet. We ran into some trouble in the north stairwell, which slowed us down," Maarika said. "The last set of schematics I saw suggested the vault would be on the other side of the building, as far from Sevastyan's office as possible."

Tisket's nose twitched in annoyance again as she rolled her dark eyes. "Because it's not like *I* would know. I wasn't hiding in the vent all day or anything. Nooo, don't ask me, the one who doesn't know anything."

"Tisket von Tasket," Dolaidh said over the comms, with practiced patience in his voice, "would you kindly share the location of Baron Sevastyan's vault, so that our team can extract the item without coming to a conclusion involving violence or incarceration?"

"Technically, Ranveig has already engaged in violence," Maarika said.

"Excessive violence," Dolaidh clarified.

"Oh, yeah, avoiding violence, like *that's* a thing we do," Tisket muttered under her breath. She looked around the room, slowly scanning each surface. The Varich baroness had said something about that vault, but it had been so quiet, or Tisket remembered it quietly, at least. Something about the vault, something new, something hard to remember, something close.

"Gib, Dolaidh, we're going to head to the other side of the floor and start searching for the vault there," Maarika said.

"Ugh, *totally* the right thing to do," Tisket said, starting to anxious pace across the office. "It can't possibly be in this exact place it feels like it should be, but obviously isn't."

Ranveig grimaced, but rather than agree with Maarika, she slipped her axe back into the holster on her belt and began to scan the room. "My lady, Tisket may have a point. Something does seem off."